

Emberkeep — weekly status report

Reporting period **30 July – 6 August 2026**. Source of record: the shared task board (*emberkeep-board*, rev 314, 111 tasks) plus the working tree. All 85 closed items below were completed between 3 and 6 August; the two workstreams are **aina** (art, assets, conversation & shop UI) and **onja** (integration & mechanisms). Note that the last *git commit* predates this period — this week's work is in the working tree, not yet committed.

85 TASKS DELIVERED	527 h ESTIMATED EFFORT CLOSED	26 TASKS REMAINING	271 h ESTIMATED EFFORT OPEN	2 PLAYABLE WORLDS (EMBERKEEP, BOREALIS)	462 UNIT TESTS GREEN
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1 · Delivered this week — 85 tasks, closed 3–6 Aug 2026

1.1 · World, zones & engine architecture (26)

ID	OWNER	WHAT SHIPPED
EMB-1	onja	Multiple grid definitions — perspective, size and matrix authored once; every zone laid out afterwards derives from it. The foundation the rest of the week stands on.
EMB-3	onja	Zone-1 / Hub / Zone-2 integration — the masked zones load, unlock and render off the grid definition.
EMB-65	onja	Map space — art-anchored coordinates so saved boards survive the world→zone→tile switch. Shipped and tested ahead of the migration, so the path had already run before it mattered.
EMB-74	onja	Port from <i>nionja</i> — GPU/power tier detection, nb2 backdrop, and the multi-world zone registry (357 cells, lossless). Non-destructive: nothing existing changed behaviour.
EMB-83	onja	Zone renderer, per-world boards, world switching — the <i>world</i> → <i>zone</i> → <i>tile</i> address model lands. Per-zone projection, unbounded projection with bounded membership, adjacency never leaves a zone.
EMB-86	onja	Travel loading veil + per-world art residency — no world costs another anything; measured on a throttled connection before building.
EMB-94	onja	World Builder authors the multi-world / multi-grid system — the tool now covers the engine's model with no gap, plus a regression test (<i>wbzonetest.mjs</i>).
EMB-81	—	Borealis (world 2) built — landmarks, the keel gold chain, seeding, and 4 world-crossing defects fixed. Every chain in the north reports RENEWABLE with zero blocking findings.
EMB-77	onja	Borealis aurora — procedural sky for world 2.
EMB-85	onja	Snowfall weather layer (SnowFX) — one quad, 5 parallax planes, ~2 265 flakes, zero CPU per flake (a particle emitter at that density would be ~136 k transform writes/second).
EMB-103	onja	Weather + aurora power-governor audit — measured in the real game at all three governor states; the doze state stops re-rendering entirely.
EMB-63	onja	Continuous FX emitters — fire and smoke/sparks/embers: engine, presets, tuning tool and regression coverage.
EMB-64	onja	World Builder FX tab — drag an emitter card onto a cell and it burns live.
EMB-110	—	Persistence fixed — the board you leave is the board you return to. A playtest was returning old state plus a spray of items the player never placed.
EMB-111	—	The road to Borealis opened — the XP gap was measured (tutorial ends at exactly 162 XP), so Level 3 now lands on the first post-tutorial order rather than being unreachable.

ID	OWNER	WHAT SHIPPED
EMB-79	—	Multi-world readiness — world-scoped quest ladder, per-world chain rosters, per-world availability proof.
EMB-61	—	Quest ladder orchestration + offline availability proof — one main quest with ordered subquests replaces two unrelated lists; <i>pnpm quests</i> proves no subquest asks for something unobtainable.
EMB-90	—	Quest ladder re-plan + tracker wording pass — every sub-row is now a verb, a number and a piece, and deliveries name the recipient.
EMB-44	—	Tutorial coverage pass — every start-of-game concept taught, no dead input; new <i>tutorial-design</i> skill + <i>ftuecheck.py</i> + the concept ledger doc.
EMB-48	—	Reachability audit — found that the new merge roster was effectively unreachable in Chapter One, and fixed it.
EMB-104	—	Design system — one UI language across every surface (<i>src/art/design.ts</i>); the game had been carrying two competing looks.
EMB-45	—	Eleanor 2.5D world standee + scepter sheets ; Flame Gem suite regenerated. Canon change: she works at a distance rather than walking to what she helps.
EMB-51	onja	World-standee de-drift bake + World Builder Characters tab — where a character stands is authored in the tool, not hand-edited in JSON.
EMB-52	onja	Character placement round-trip fixed — Eleanor was anchored on a void rim cell; plus a slower standee idle with breath.
EMB-55	onja	World Builder free character placement , pinned to the game's own cell frame instead of guessing it.
EMB-56	onja	Eleanor idle = breath only (frame loop off) plus her ground shadow.
EMB-60	aina	Standee bake fixed — margin + cut-edge feather so no cast frame clips, with her feet unmoved to the pixel.
EMB-76	onja	Dev-server runaway watch→rebuild loop stopped — allow-list watcher plus a circuit breaker. A root <i>pnpm dev</i> had once rebuilt for ~29 min on 16 threads.
EMB-47	—	HUD right-column overlap fixed + the missing <code>ITEM_SCALE</code> entries for the whole merge roster.

1.2 · Gameplay systems (24)

ID	OWNER	WHAT SHIPPED
EMB-4	onja	Dragon feeding system — dragons come off the merge chains and are fed instead.
EMB-99	onja	Taste model — favourite / accepted / refused, with servings-based growth.
EMB-40	onja	Dragon caretaking — three separate daily axes (fuel, grit, green), dislikes, and Trust payoffs. Grit and drink never substitute for each other.
EMB-20	onja	Trust system — 0–5, at most +1/day, never decays (a test advances five days of absence and asserts no loss); digging and foraging payoffs.
EMB-19	onja	Cold Nest acquisition loop — a dragon is <i>coaxed</i> (9 points, $\leq 3/\text{day}$), never bought, dropped or merged.
EMB-21	onja	Four-phase day clock (morning / day / dusk / night) — the thing Trust and Growth count days against.
EMB-112	onja	Ambient dragon life — wander, sleep and hungry roar, plus red-dragon sleep art. Board dragons stopped being furniture.
EMB-113	onja	Sleep unified on every path — one curled painting with one breath, whichever way a dragon fell asleep; cozy cadence retune.
EMB-66	onja	Dragon work-return state fixed (dragons floated after a shift), dragon drop = shards, emberberry tree chain.
EMB-105	onja	The Fir loop — a worked tree seeds its replacement — plus the House's commission.

ID	OWNER	WHAT SHIPPED
EMB-17	onja	chains.json Layer A + B wired — 9 new chains reach the board.
EMB-69	onja	Ash Moss opens the game — the isle's green is the first thing the player makes.
EMB-70	onja	Timber milling chain , emberberry bonus yield, and the plant + wood art.
EMB-42	onja	Recipient locking made absolute — Eleanor's chains are hers alone; no dragon eats quartz or moonwater at any tier.
EMB-62	onja	Selling moves into the Bag — nothing on the board can be sold; the new merge roster is held until the chapter that owns it.
EMB-29	onja	Bag system — tap a piece to store it (it arcs to the satchel), retrieve from the panel; drag still merges.
EMB-87	onja	Production mode — demo scaffolding removed: level_5 is reachable, and the awakening moves off the level cap onto its quest.
EMB-71	onja	Demo teaser tail stripped — the finale ends on the Elder and hands the board straight back; no glimpse, no "keep playing?" card.
EMB-32	onja	Story chapter pointer — one persisted integer (1..12) owned by StorySystem, gating dialogue bank selection.
EMB-38	onja	World characters — characters.json, WorldCharacterSystem (anchors, cooldowns, action dispatch); Eleanor stands in Emberkeep and can be asked for help.
EMB-59	onja	Tutorial fixes — Eleanor's arrow follows her authored anchor instead of a hardcoded tile; Moonwater gets its own merge beat.
EMB-35	—	story-qa skill — automated coherence audit across 4 story docs and 6 data files, because the failure mode there is silent.
EMB-10	aina	Merge item art — 13 chains / 35 icons (5 goods + 4 producers + 4 Borealis), keyed to clean alpha, trimmed, webp'd and registered.
EMB-13	aina	Producer art — Firepine, Cinder Vein, Dew Basin, Cold Nest (8 assets, 185 KB).

1.3 · Characters, dragons & animation (17)

ID	OWNER	WHAT SHIPPED
EMB-12	onja	Cast replacement — Cindra and Laurah removed entirely; Eleanor is both guide and quest giver. 21 tutorial steps, 4 orders + 4 repeatables re-voiced (not name-swapped), 72 MB of art deleted, SAVE_VERSION → 7.
EMB-5	aina	3D character assets generated — eleanor.glb, selyna.glb.
EMB-36	onja	Portrait atlas grid + per-speaker animator + speaker crossfade — the hardcoded 8x8 atlas was the blocker (Selyna needs 79 cells before expressions); it now computes per speaker.
EMB-49	aina	Merge-style animated Eleanor + Selyna (talk + blink), re-skinned from Laurah and driving the dialogue bubble portrait.
EMB-11	aina	Golden Elder dialogue set — rest, 4 blink and 4 talk frames + portrait, region-composited so there is zero crossfade ghosting by construction.
EMB-54	onja	Eleanor polish — bubble breathing damped from a rubbery wobble; Ledger portrait framed in the gold medallion.
EMB-68	onja	In-game Eleanor standee trimmed 30% and anchored at her feet (solved through the bake, not by editing generated constants).
EMB-97	onja	Selyna placed in Borealis at the lit threshold beside the magic door, with Eleanor's full standee treatment.
EMB-102	onja	Regard — the five hearts for Eleanor and Selyna: the human counterpart of a dragon's Trust, on the same gauge shape.

ID	OWNER	WHAT SHIPPED
EMB-78	aina	dragonbreed.py — repeatable breed/skin pipeline off an existing rig, plus the first breed produced by it (Frost).
EMB-88	aina	dragon-forge skill — the pipeline corrected by what the 10-sheet run taught, saved as an invocable skill.
EMB-84	aina	Three breeds + two skins (storm / mossback / moonwhisker, ashglass / porcelain), both life stages — 10 sheets with genuinely distinct silhouettes.
EMB-92	aina	Key art for storm / mossback / moonwhisker — Seedream 5.0 Pro breed cards at 900×506.
EMB-95	aina	Dragon art-direction pass — mossback cut, frost promoted to a true breed, joint-aware keyline, storm hatchling de-aged. Each correction became a pipeline rule.
EMB-107	—	Blink + roar banks for frost / storm / moonwhisker , young and adult — 12 banks, 48 frames, calibrated at IoU 100%.
EMB-100	—	Stormcap + Nightbloom chains — every feedable breed gets a favourite of its own, and the roster gains a second cooling chain.
EMB-58	onja	Standee ground shadow retuned — wider, not deeper, nudged left.

1.4 · UI, shop & presentation (18)

ID	OWNER	WHAT SHIPPED
EMB-8	onja	Quest tracker (<i>src/ui/QuestTracker.ts</i>) — main quest with an indented, scrollable sub-quest list; no background plate (legibility from stroke + shadow); gold rule sweep on completion; scroll input rect-tested rather than zoned, so it never swallows board taps.
EMB-25	aina	Eleanor's arrival — the new opening — 7 tap-gated beats replacing the old lore cards, with a beat that fires after the player's first merge.
EMB-67	aina	Ember Emporium rebuilt to the Seedream shop concept, plus a second pass on merchandising.
EMB-89	aina	Emporium shelf — a row list replaces three tall showcase cards that left the panel mostly empty.
EMB-96	—	Emporium Dragons shelf complete — five dragons, two rarity tiers, Frost on a full-height foil hero card; everything buyable actually changes the board.
EMB-91	onja	Ashglass + Porcelain live in the Emporium — key art, baked board skins, and a dragon wardrobe slot.
EMB-109	—	Emporium landmarks (5 monuments) + a full-screen dragon reveal card with a synthesised roar.
EMB-53	aina	Emporium HUD button added at column slot 2 (later consolidated by EMB-80).
EMB-80	aina	One shop button in the HUD — two near-duplicate market-stall icons collapsed into one.
EMB-75	aina	Manor skins v2 — silhouette-first archetypes (mushroom, windmill, treehouse, igloo) replacing four red-tiled boxes that all read as the same house.
EMB-73	aina	Bag item menu — an anchored popover replaces two overlapping Drop/Sell plates.
EMB-57	aina	HUD icons restyled — satchel and Emporium stall brought onto the Cookbook's art style; they were the two odd ones out.
EMB-82	aina	Quest icon — real art replaces the last runtime-painted HUD placeholder.
EMB-72	aina	One coin everywhere — real gold coin art replaces the 🌐 emoji in four places.
EMB-50	—	Layer C (Borealis chains), 4 Manor skins, 8 decors and the Keeper's Store — 25 new assets registered.
EMB-104	—	Design system — see §1.1; listed here because it is what makes the panels above read as one product.

ID	OWNER	WHAT SHIPPED
EMB-47	—	HUD column spacing — the Bag button had been inserted 36 units from the Cookbook and overlapped it.
EMB-45	—	Flame Gem suite regenerated alongside the standee work.

2 · In flight — 5 tasks, started or awaiting sign-off

ID	STATUS	OWNER	STATE AND WHAT IS LEFT
EMB-101	Review critical	onja	World switch — arrival was silent, invisible and pointed the wrong way. Root cause found by driving the real switch in a preview build: BoardScene relaunched UIScene on every journey, and Phaser's <i>launch</i> on a running scene destroys it — so every pending delayed beat died with it and Selyna's five authored arrival lines never played. One of three fixes is verified live; two are written but unverified because the working tree did not build at the time. Left: re-run <i>pnpm verify</i> now that the blocking work has landed, then close.
EMB-106	Review	—	Status readout + the feeding / fir / commission tutorials. Hearts moved off the standees' heads into a new StatusPanel under the quest tracker: one five-heart gauge for "how does this person or animal feel about me", selected on tap or flashed for 3 s when a value moves. Typecheck, 446 unit tests, build and ftuecheck green; e2e not yet run (needs go-ahead). Left: e2e pass and sign-off.
EMB-6	Review	onja	Integration of the 3D characters — rig hookup, placement and runtime for eleanor.glb / selyna.glb. The 2.5D standee path shipped instead this week, so this is the swap-in behind it.
EMB-18	Active	onja	Dragons become named companions — remove the hatch-merge branch, take companions off the grid as BoardItems, prompt for a name on acquisition and persist it. Rule: anything on the merge board is anonymous and consumable; anything with a name never touches it. Unblocks EMB-22.
EMB-23	Active	onja	Hub integration — prop placement, persistence and the world plumbing for a decorable hub. Must not become a mandatory errand loop, and entering must not disturb the sanctuary's state.

3 · Remaining — board backlog — 21 open tasks, ~271 h estimated

3.1 · Story & quest content (the largest single block)

ID	STATUS	OWNER	WHAT REMAINS
EMB-31	Ready high	aina	Campaign dialogue — 12 chapters + the recurring banks. Every final line is already written in <i>docs/script-chapters.md</i> ; this is delivery into the data files, not authoring. Volume comes from the recurring banks rather than the scene beats. 16 h.
EMB-33	Ready high	onja	Quest ladder — 12 quests + GIVE, Regard and Growth. Enforces the coherence rule: a chapter beat may only presuppose what its quest made true. Includes the two one-shot fixtures (Dead Ember, Long Hearth) that respond to the hidden power — exactly two in all of world 1. 20 h.
EMB-24	Ready	aina	Golden Elder speaks. Her art, both banks and her speaker entry all ship; only the wiring is missing — drive the banks from the dialogue bubble and land her line on the shared FINALE timeline. She must speak nowhere earlier. 8 h.
EMB-34	Ready	aina	Keepsake art — 8 gift items + the give animation (the reverse of the store flight). They must not read as merge items: no tier badge, no matched-set silhouette. 8 h.

ID	STATUS	OWNER	WHAT REMAINS
EMB-37	Ready high	aina	Disc atlases + expression cells + letter panel. Eleanor 69 cells, Selyna 87, Elder 10; plus Selyna's five world-1 letters rendered with a wax seal where the portrait would be. Unblocked now that EMB-36 computes the grid. 12 h.
EMB-7	Ready	aina	Monologue bubble — bubble art and the text treatment for monologue lines. 8 h.

3.2 · Gameplay systems & open decisions

ID	STATUS	OWNER	WHAT REMAINS
EMB-41	Ready	onja	Trust as conduct — Trust 1 (stops backing away), 3 (takes food from your hand) and 5 (follows you between zones) are animation and movement, not state, and are still invisible. Also: adult companions cannot work, because DragonJobSystem only knows legacy BoardItem dragons. 14 h.
EMB-22	Backlog	onja	Preference discovery — likes and dislikes hidden until fed; a refusal is itself a discovery; reveal chance scales with tier (10/25/60%). A wrong guess must never harm the dragon. Blocked on EMB-18. 16 h.
EMB-108	Ready	aina	Legendary dragon per zone — the system is built and enforced by the quest audit (three eggs, one per quest, spaced, hatching last). Only 4 art keys remain. 4 h.
EMB-30	Decision	onja	Bag or bubbles for board-full overflow. The design specifies both, which would give the game two answers to "where did my item go". Pick one and strike the other from the docs. 2 h.
EMB-43	Decision	onja	Crystal Balls — land-gated or dragon-gated? Locking Eleanor's chains removed quartz's self-balancing property, so each dragon is now a permanent +1.9 pebbles/hour. Wants deciding before the economy is tuned for real. 2 h.

3.3 · Art & world content

ID	STATUS	OWNER	WHAT REMAINS
EMB-98	Ready	aina	Borealis art — 6 pieces. The Wrack Line, the Hoarfrost Font and the 4-tier keel chain. The only thing left before Borealis is finished; these six keys currently render as painted placeholders. 4 h.
EMB-16	Backlog	aina	Borealis dragon set + Selyna expression pass. Cold-adapted breeds at parity with the red/emerald rigs (same part breakdown), plus Selyna's 8 expression plates. 16 h.
EMB-2	Backlog high	aina	Zone-1, Hub and Zone-2 masking — cut the playable-area masks against the grid definition. 14 h.
EMB-15	Backlog	aina	Hub art — the decoration set and the shop frontage, on the hub art direction (high morning light, cyan-green, cloud-sea). It must not read as Emberkeep with the lava turned off. 14 h.
EMB-39	Ready	aina	World-character blockout — painted placeholder standees so placement and feel can be judged before any 3D exists. 5 h.
EMB-46	Ready	—	Play Eleanor's scepter cast. Eight co-registered cast frames and an 8-frame idle loop exist and nothing plays them; her help still resolves instantly with no visible cast. Wants the ember bolt travelling to the target tile. 4 h.

3.4 · Hub, shop & the Dragon Book

ID	STATUS	OWNER	WHAT REMAINS
EMB-27	Backlog	aina	Shop relocation into the hub — shop UI, frontage interaction, Warmth and Gold purchase flows, and no purchase path left on the board HUD. Watch travel friction. 12 h.
EMB-26	Backlog	aina	Dragon Book panel — entry cards, discovered vs undiscovered rows, discovered-count, purchase at the first hub. Placed as a tab beside the Cookbook. Depends on EMB-14 and EMB-22. 12 h.
EMB-14	Backlog	aina	Dragon Book art — frame, entry card and four states (locked, bought-empty, partial, full). An undiscovered row must read as "not tried yet", never as a field withheld to sell you something. 10 h.
EMB-28	Ready	aina	Bag art — the satchel button half is delivered (EMB-57); the panel frame and slot states (filled, hovered, unfilled) remain, matching the concept at a glance. 8 h.

4 · Remaining — heavy polish & optimization — not yet on the board; the pass that turns "all systems shipped" into "it feels finished"

Everything in §1 landed in four days, and much of it landed *alongside* other in-flight work. The items below are the deliberate quality pass across the four axes named: they are derived from the state of the tree rather than copied from the board, and should be added to it as tasks.

AXIS	ITEM	WHAT IT MEANS, AND WHY IT MATTERS
UX	Full e2e verification sweep	Several of the most recent passes shipped on typecheck + unit + build only, with e2e explicitly deferred (EMB-106 among them). One authorised end-to-end run across the tutorial, the world switch and a return-from-reload is the single highest-value confidence step available right now.
	First-session flow re-audit	The tutorial ledger (<i>docs/tutorial-coverage.md</i>) was written before feeding, Trust, Regard, the Bag verbs, the status panel and world travel all landed. Re-run the coverage audit so every concept now on screen still has a teach-point and no input is dead.
	HUD density & portrait pass	The right column has absorbed a bag, a shop, a quest tracker and now a status panel in one week. Re-check spacing, tap targets and legibility at portrait aspect on a real device, not just at 2560×1600.
	One overflow model	Resolve EMB-30 and remove the losing option from the docs. Two answers to "where did my item go" is a UX defect even when both work.
	Travel friction	With the hub and shop moving off the board (EMB-23, EMB-27), audit how many taps and loading veils a routine purchase costs. A place the player must visit for every transaction is a corridor.
	Reload & interruption states	Persistence was fixed this week (EMB-110); extend the same scrutiny to being interrupted mid-dialogue, mid-travel and mid-feeding.
Story	Coherence re-run after the ladder	Run the <i>story-qa</i> skill again once EMB-31 and EMB-33 land together. The reveal ladder, the chapter contracts and the data files must agree; the failure mode is silent, which is why the skill exists.
	Voice consistency pass	Eleanor absorbed two characters' lines (EMB-12) and the campaign banks are about to triple her word count. One editorial pass for a single voice, especially where guide lines and quest lines sit adjacent.
	Pacing of the reveal ladder	Twelve chapters, two one-shot fixtures and a finale that must remain the strongest beat. Verify no reveal can land out of order under fast or slow play, and that the Elder stays silent until she wakes.
	Letters as a read experience	Selyna is read for weeks before she is seen (EMB-37). The letter panel needs its own typographic care — it is not a dialogue bubble with different art.

TYPE	ITEM	WHAT IT MEANS, AND WHY IT MATTERS
Quest	Availability proof on every ladder edit	<i>pnpm quests</i> already classifies every piece RENEWABLE / FINITE / UNREACHABLE and is enforced by a unit test. Keep it green across the 12-quest ladder and both worlds — one pre-existing <i>radiant_centerpiece</i> warning is still outstanding.
	Economy tuning against the real ladder	Gold, Warmth, dig rates and order rewards were tuned against the demo. With commissions, the Fir loop, the Emporium and companion income all live, retune end-to-end — and settle EMB-43 first, since it changes the slope.
	Tracker wording & completion beats	The wording rule (verb, number, piece) is established; apply it to every new chapter quest, and confirm the gold-sweep completion beat reads correctly when several subquests finish at once.
	Reward spacing across chapters	The legendary arc is spaced by rule (EMB-108); the other 12 quests are not yet checked for reward rhythm — back-to-back payouts flatten the ladder.
Animation	Eleanor's cast (EMB-46)	Finished art that never plays. Idle loop at rest, one-shot cast on help, ember bolt to the target tile — this is the animation that sells the canon change to working at a distance.
	Trust expressed as conduct (EMB-41)	Trust 1, 3 and 5 are meant to be visible behaviour, not a bar. Until they animate, three-fifths of the relationship system is invisible to the player.
	Give animation (EMB-34)	Reuse the store-flight curve in reverse so gifting reads as the motion players already know, with a recipient reaction on landing.
	Transition polish	World arrival, panel opens, the reveal card and the finale all animate independently. One pass for shared easing and timing so the game has a single motion language, the way EMB-104 gave it a single visual one.
	Idle life audit	Ambient dragon life, sleep, breath and blink all shipped this week from different tasks. Check them running together at length — unison blinking, competing tweens on one sprite and overlapping wanders are the classic regressions here.
Optimization	Power-governor audit of everything new	The aurora and snow were audited (EMB-103). The FX emitters, dragon life, the status panel and the reveal card were not. No system may be an autonomous wake source.
	Per-world asset residency budget	Residency works today with two worlds (EMB-86). Measure again with the Borealis art, the new breeds and the hub loaded, against the 4096 px old-device ceiling.
	Texture & atlas budget	Five breeds × two stages × blink/roar banks, plus expression atlases at 69–87 cells, plus key art. Re-measure total resident texture memory on the low tier.
	Commit the week's work	The last commit predates this reporting period: all 85 delivered tasks currently live in the working tree. Landing them in reviewable commits is a prerequisite for any of the above being safely revisable.

Prepared from the emberkeep task board (rev 314) and the repository working tree, 6 August 2026. Sections 1–3 are the board's own record; section 4 is derived and should be entered onto the board as tasks.